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Afghanistan will host Bangladesh and Zimbabwe in a packed October-November multi-format series in the UAE. It starts with a one-off Test between Afghanistan and Bangladesh (October 9-13), followed by an ODI Tri-Series involving all three teams (October 17-23). Afghanistan and Zimbabwe then play a three-match T20I series (October 27-November 1), before wrapping up the tour with a two-match Test series, scheduled for November 5-9 and November 13-17.



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England has appointed former Ashes-winning batter Kevin Pietersen to its white-ball coaching staff. Pietersen, 46, will take on the role of specialist mentor, beginning with England's upcoming T20 and one-day series against Sri Lanka. He will also be part of the coaching setup for this winter's tours of Australia and South Africa, before returning for next summer's home series against Pakistan and New Zealand. Pietersen is also set to work with the team at the 2027 ODI World Cup, which will be staged in South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia.



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The ICC has confirmed India as the new host of the inaugural Women's Champions Trophy, which was originally scheduled to be held in Sri Lanka. The tournament will take place from February 14 to 28, 2027, with matches set to be played at two venues: the Cricket Club of India's Brabourne Stadium in Mumbai and the Vadodara International Cricket Stadium in Vadodara.



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India and Japan will meet for the first time in an international match when they face off in a men's T20I in Japan. The historic fixture will be played on September 22 at the Sano International Cricket Ground in Tochigi Prefecture, kicking off celebrations marking the 75th anniversary of diplomatic relations between India and Japan. Both teams are also set to compete in the men's cricket tournament at the 2026 Asian Games.

South Africa underlined its credentials with a thumping 48-run victory over Zimbabwe in the T20I Tri-Series final in Windhoek. After piling on 205 for 5, the Proteas bowled Zimbabwe out for 157 to claim the title. The series brought together South Africa, Zimbabwe and hosts Namibia, the three co-hosts of the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2027, offering an early rehearsal for next year's global tournament at a venue that will also stage World Cup matches.

Dewald Brevis (**in pic**) was named Player of the Series after scoring 226 runs at a strike rate of 166.18, including 15 fours and 16 sixes.



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